

The best ads on Meta, Google and more don't look like ads.

12 formats that read like organic content. When to use each one, which industry it fits, and what makes **Meta, Google and TikTok** reject it.

How to use this guide

Every format comes with a card you can use the same day: where it performs, where it does not, the mistakes that ruin it, and what gets it rejected on each platform.

● Low risk

Approved without friction if you respect the basics.

● Use with care

It passes, but one design or copy detail takes it down.

● High risk

Only in the safe version the card describes.

01 12 formats

Cards, pages 05 to 16 · Matrix, page 17

02 Rules of the game

What all three platforms reject, pages 19 to 21

03 Checklist

Review before you launch, page 22



The rule that sums it all up

Looking like content is allowed. Faking a feature, impersonating someone or inventing social proof is not.

00 THE DATA

Why native format wins

An ad with an ad's face triggers the scroll-past reflex. One that looks like something a friend sent you buys a second more of attention.

+33%

CTR of UGC-style creative against polished, across more than 12,000 ads.

Benly, 2026

+31%

Hook rate of unpolished creative. It holds more in the first seconds.

Benly, 2026

60/40

The native/polished mix of top accounts. It beats either one alone by 18 to 25% of ROAS.

Benly, 2026

+22%

View-through rate of ads imitating creator content against brand videos.

TikTok Creative Center, via EmberTribe



What nobody tells you

There are no public format-by-format studies. These figures measure native style in general, and polished still wins on high ticket and brand perception. The practical conclusion: launch several formats at once and let your own data decide.

01

12 formats that don't look like ads.

One card per format. Read it, pick two or three, and launch them this week.

01 Messaging chat

02 Story aesthetic

03 Notes app note

04 Text post

05 Comment reply

06 Comment thread

07 Review screenshot

08 Editorial style

09 Search and autocomplete

10 Checklist

11 Voice note

12 Email screenshot

01

FORMAT 01 OF 12

● Use with care

Messaging chat

A conversation between two people where your product shows up as the answer to a real question.

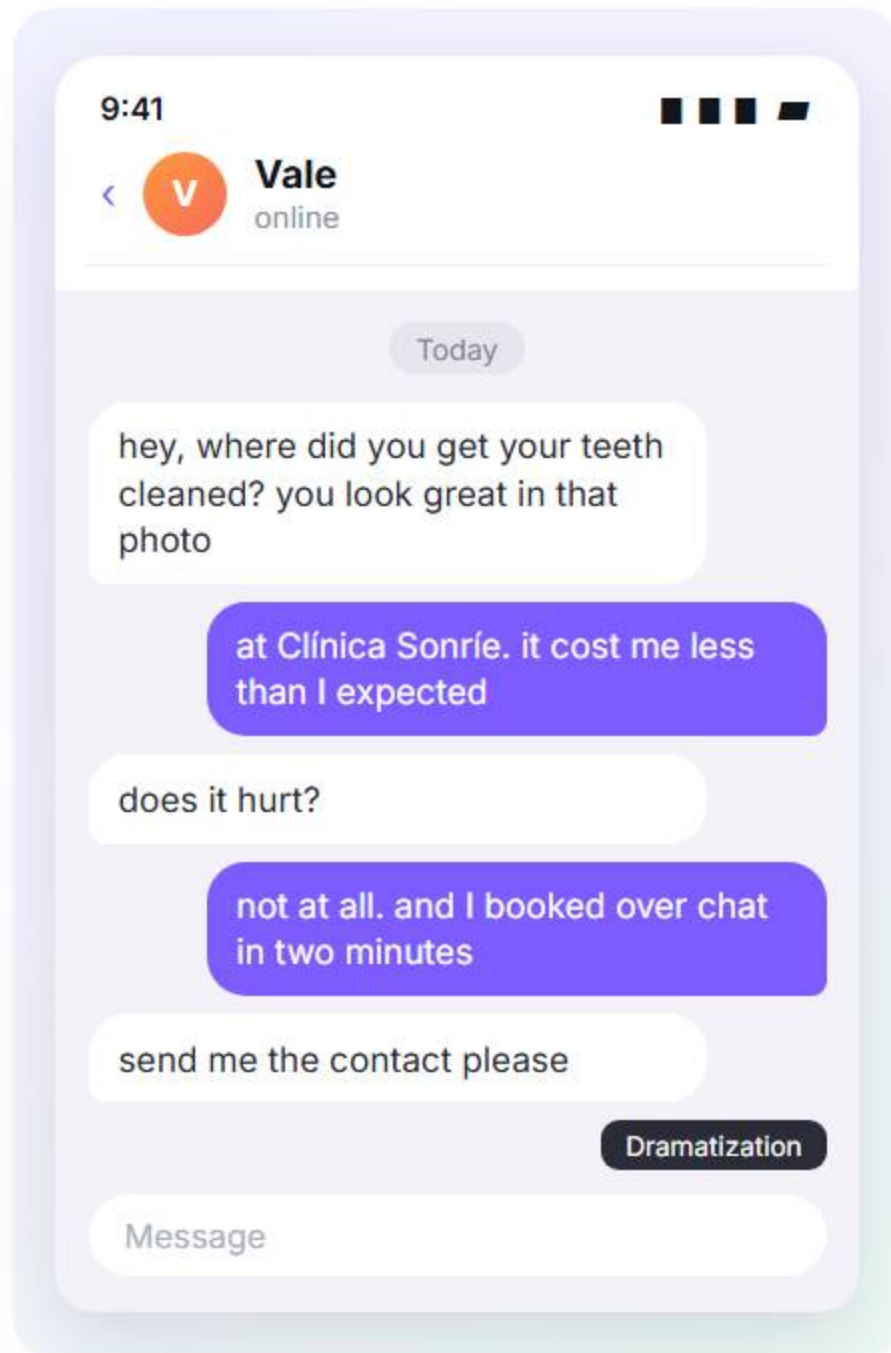
FITS

Local services

Health and beauty

Education

Apps



✓ Use it when

- Services people recommend over chat: clinics, courses, apps, local services.
- Retargeting that answers one concrete objection: price, pain, time.

✗ Avoid it when

- Products that need to be seen: fashion, decor, food.
- The chat invents a customer vouching for a result.

MISTAKES THAT RUIN IT

- 01 Using WhatsApp's green, icons or logo.
- 02 Dialogue that sounds like a sales script.
- 03 More than six bubbles. Nobody reads them.

What gets it rejected

FLAGGED FOR

An interface or logo identical to WhatsApp (a Meta trademark, permission required). A message presented as the testimony of a real customer who does not exist.

● Meta

● Google

● TikTok

HOW TO PASS

A generic interface in your own colour. A small dramatization label. Nothing that looks like a button.

02

FORMAT 02 OF 12

● Low risk

Story aesthetic

A vertical piece that looks like somebody's story: handwritten text, an unproduced photo, zero corporate template.

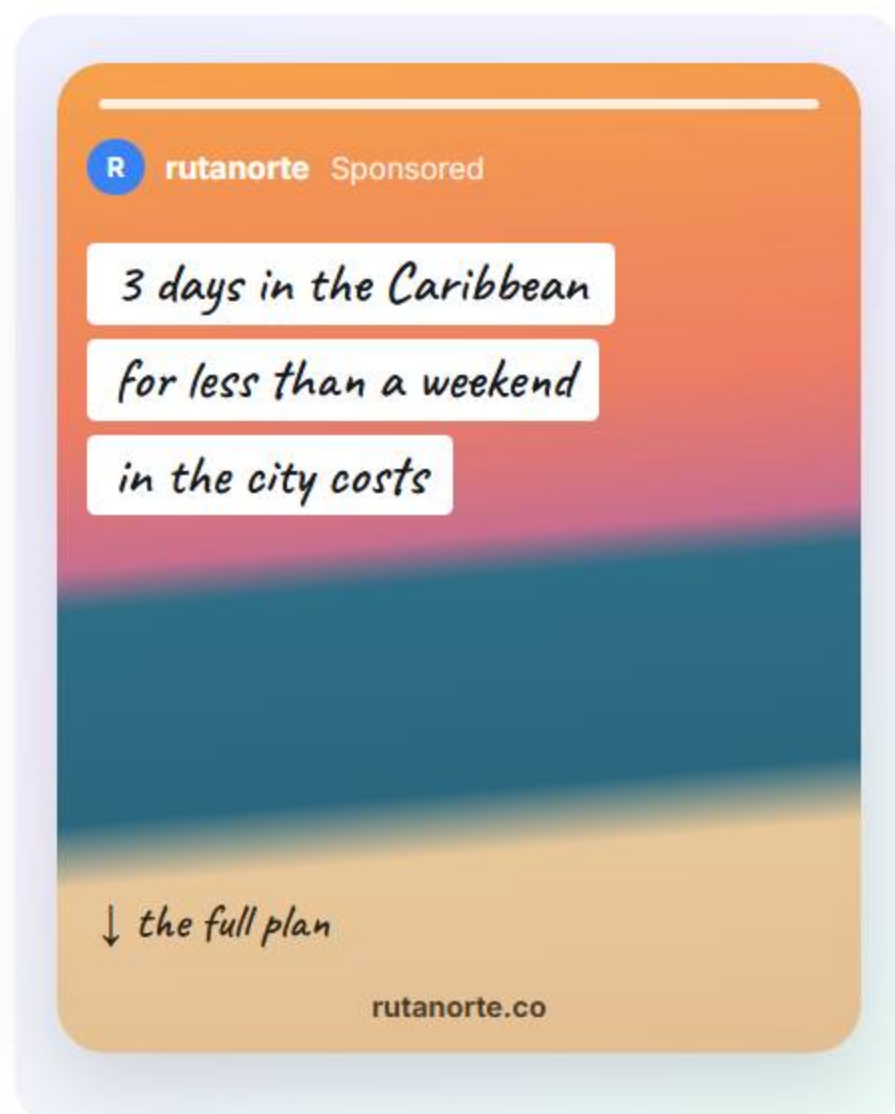
FITS

Ecommerce

Travel

Food

Fashion



✓ Use it when

- Stories and Reels placements, where it is literally native.
- Launches, dated offers, behind the scenes.

✗ Avoid it when

- In a 1:1 feed it loses the whole effect.
- Products that need a lot of explaining.

MISTAKES THAT RUIN IT

- 01 Poll or link stickers that do not work.
- 02 Text in the zone that covers the interface.
- 03 A stock photo.

What gets it rejected

FLAGGED FOR

Fake interactive stickers. A multi-slide progress bar inside a single image: TikTok treats it as a false indicator.

● Meta

● Google

● TikTok

HOW TO PASS

Text and drawing, not working stickers. A single bar. Leave the top and bottom 14% clear.

03

FORMAT 03 OF 12

● Low risk

Notes app note

A screenshot of a note with an honest list. It looks like something someone wrote for themselves at eleven at night.

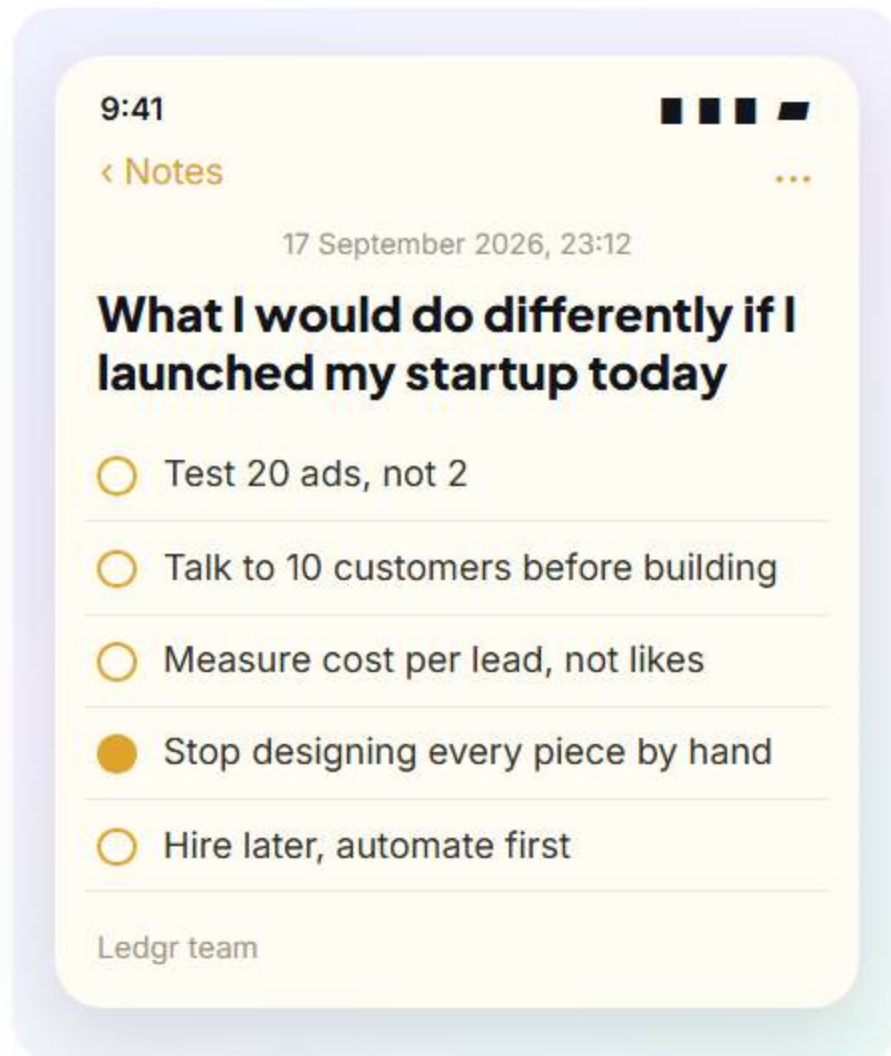
FITS

SaaS

Education

Professional services

Personal finance



Use it when

- B2B, SaaS, courses, professional services.
- The cheapest format to test: ten variations in an hour.



Avoid it when

- If you have no idea with substance to tell.
- Products whose value is visual.

MISTAKES THAT RUIN IT

- 01 Too much text.
- 02 The brand on the first line.
- 03 Vague "change your life" promises.

What gets it rejected

FLAGGED FOR

Almost never flagged. The risk appears if the list promises income, cures or guaranteed results.

● Meta

● Google

● TikTok

HOW TO PASS

Promises you can prove. The brand at the end, as a signature.

04

FORMAT 04 OF 12

Low risk

Text post

An opinion in post format: avatar, name and text. The voice of a person, not of a logo.

FITS

SaaS

B2B

Education

Finance

9:41



Mariana Rojas

Founder of Mesa · 2 h

We stopped paying a design agency and our cost per lead halved.

Not because design does not matter. Because we used to test 3 ads a month and now we test 40.

The product did not change. What changed is how many times we asked the market.

♡ 86 ◻ 14 ↻ 5



Use it when

- Founder personal brand and B2B.
- Strong opinions, lessons, your own numbers. Performs on LinkedIn and Meta.



Avoid it when

- If the person does not exist or never said that.
- With photos of someone famous.

MISTAKES THAT RUIN IT

- 01 Inventing the expert.
- 02 A fake verified badge.
- 03 Inflated like counters.

What gets it rejected

FLAGGED FOR

A public figure's face without permission: Meta detects it with facial recognition (celeb-bait). Invented engagement metrics.

Meta

Google

TikTok

HOW TO PASS

A real person from your team signs it, with their authorisation. No badges. Modest numbers or none.

05

FORMAT 05 OF 12

Low risk

Comment reply

A video answering a question from a real comment. The most native format on TikTok and Reels.

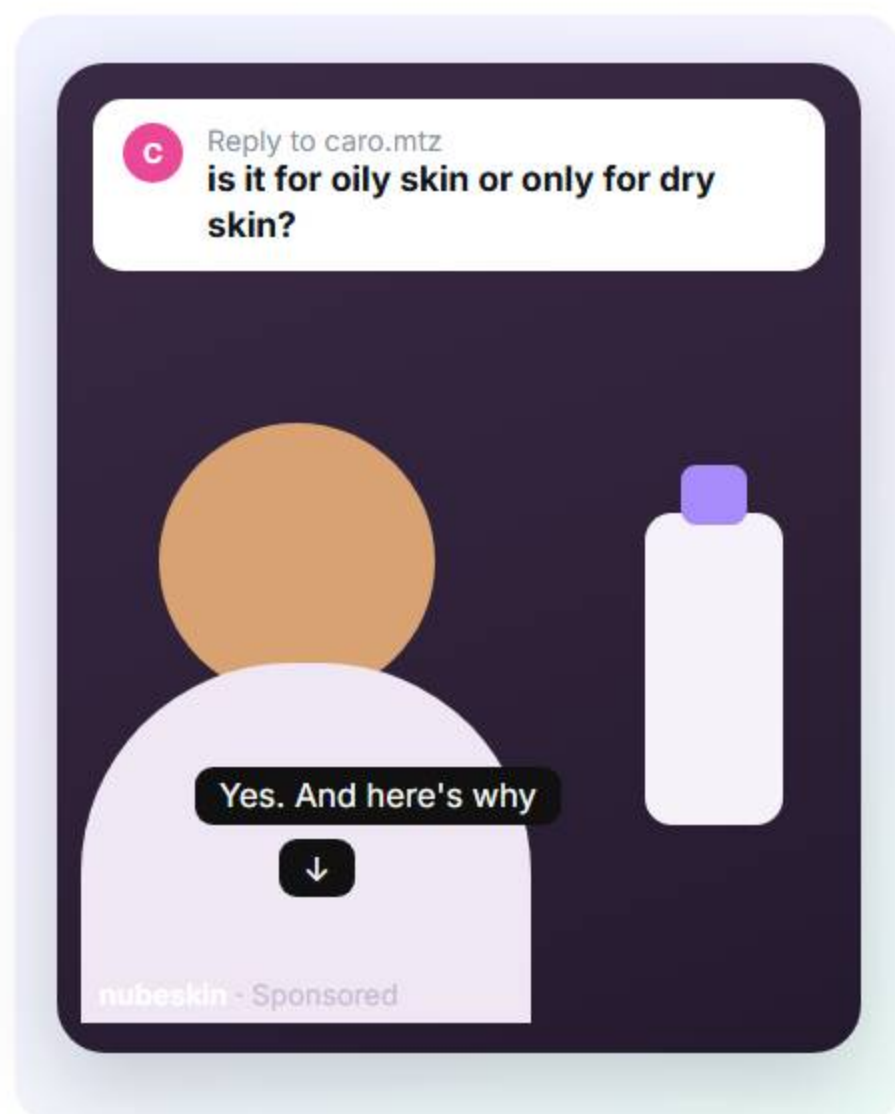
FITS

Ecommerce

Health and beauty

Apps

Education



✓ Use it when

- Resolving objections: price, size, shipping, "is it for me?".
- Products with frequent questions.

✗ Avoid it when

- If the comment is made up.
- If you answer something nobody asks.

MISTAKES THAT RUIN IT

- 01 A comment written by the brand.
- 02 Polished video that breaks the tone.
- 03 An answer longer than 30 seconds.

What gets it rejected

FLAGGED FOR

The comment has to exist. Inventing it is a false testimonial before the FTC and European rules.

Meta

Google

TikTok

HOW TO PASS

Use real comments from your ads or organic. On TikTok, Spark Ads promotes the original post.

06

FORMAT 06 OF 12

● Use with care

Comment thread

A question and several stacked answers, like a forum. The social proof of someone who does not know you.

FITS

SaaS

Apps

Finance

Electronics

9:41

Question · Flatshare

Which app do you use to split flat expenses?

There are 4 of us and we always end up arguing over the electricity bill.

L

lucia_b

Parte. The best part is it tells you who owes what, nobody has to chase anyone.

▲ 32 · reply

J

jp.ortiz

I tried three. I stayed with Parte because it splits by usage, not in equal parts.

▲ 19 · reply

S

sofi

+1 for Parte

▲ 7 · reply

Illustrative example



Use it when

- Categories where people ask for opinions before buying: software, electronics, personal finance.



Avoid it when

- If the answers are invented and presented as real.
- Imitating a real, well-known forum.

MISTAKES THAT RUIN IT

- 01 Every answer is praise.
- 02 Names that sound fake.
- 03 Inflated votes.

What gets it rejected

● Meta

● Google

● TikTok

FLAGGED FOR

Fabricated answers are false social proof: an unfair practice in the EU and prohibited by the FTC. An interface identical to a real forum.

HOW TO PASS

Real comments with permission, or label it as an illustrative example. A generic interface.

07

FORMAT 07 OF 12

● High risk

Review screenshot

Stars, a name and text. The most powerful social proof, and also the most closely watched by regulators.

FITS

Ecommerce

Food

Health and beauty

Education



Straight blue jean

Trama · Size 30



Daniela P.

Verified purchase · 3 days ago



It arrived in two days and the size was exact. That had never happened to me buying jeans online. I already ordered the second one.



Good fabric. The blue is a bit darker than in the photo.

Andrés M. · Verified purchase

Real reviews, used with permission



Use it when

- When you have real reviews: ecommerce, restaurants, clinics, courses.
- Abandoned cart retargeting.



Avoid it when

- Never with reviews written by the brand.
- Never with AI-generated reviews.

MISTAKES THAT RUIN IT

- 01 Editing the customer's text.
- 02 Showing only the five-star ones as if they were all.
- 03 Google or Trustpilot logos without permission.

What gets it rejected

● Meta

● Google

● TikTok

FLAGGED FOR

The FTC fines up to US\$51,744 per violation and it covers AI-written reviews. In Spain, adding or commissioning fake reviews is unfair competition.

HOW TO PASS

A real review, unedited, with the customer's authorisation. If you can, say where it is published.

08

FORMAT 08 OF 12

● High risk

Editorial style

Headline, photo and standfirst with the look of an article. It works if it is your own publication, not if it pretends to be a newspaper.

FITS

Health and beauty

Home

Finance

Education

Green Notebook

BRANDED CONTENT

HOME · TRENDS

Why balcony vegetable gardens are replacing decorative plants



By the Casa Verde team · 6 min read

Placeholder text for the article body.



Use it when

- Branded content with a story: your own data, cases, launches.
- With a coherent advertorial on the landing page.



Avoid it when

- With a real outlet's name, logo or typeface.
- With "news" about celebrities.

MISTAKES THAT RUIN IT

- 01 Inventing an outlet that looks real.
- 02 Using celebrities.
- 03 Promising money or cures.

What gets it rejected

FLAGGED FOR

Meta prohibits misrepresenting a news outlet to promise benefits. Google rejects anything disguised as news. It is the classic scam pattern.

● Meta

● Google

● TikTok

HOW TO PASS

A masthead with your brand. A visible branded content label. A landing page that says the same thing.

09

FORMAT 09 OF 12

● Use with care

Search and autocomplete

A search bar with the question your customer is already asking. Your brand is the answer.

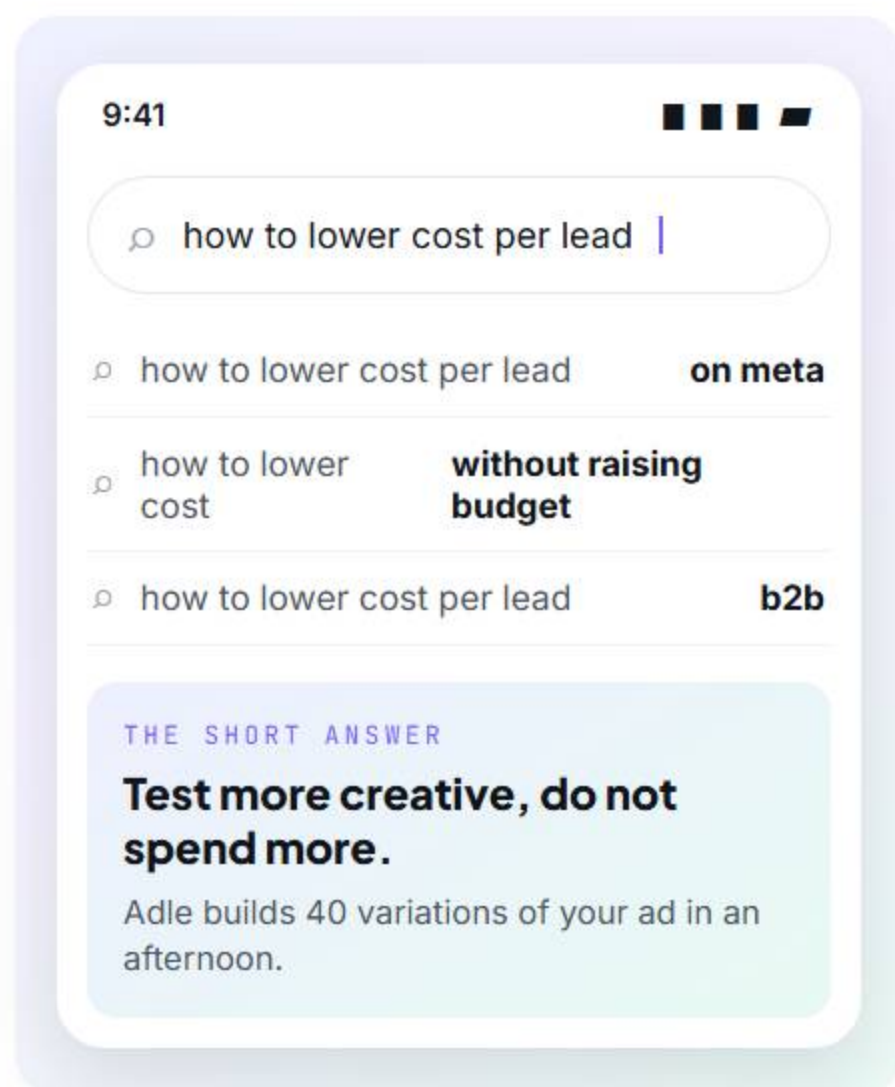
FITS

SaaS

Professional services

Education

Apps



✓ Use it when

- Problems people search with "how" or "why".
- SaaS, services, education.

✗ Avoid it when

- On Google Ads: it gets confused with a real result.
- If it simulates a results page.

MISTAKES THAT RUIN IT

- 01 Google's logo or colours.
- 02 A list of fake results.
- 03 A "Search" button that looks clickable.

What gets it rejected

● Meta

● Google

● TikTok

FLAGGED FOR

A search engine's registered trademark. Google restricts ads that cannot be told apart from its own content, and buttons without context.

HOW TO PASS

A generic bar with no brand. No simulated results. The answer goes as your ad copy.

10

FORMAT 10 OF 12

● Low risk

Checklist

A list with ticked boxes and one unticked: your product is the thing that is missing.

FITS

Local services

Travel

SaaS

Events

9:41



List

Moving · Saturday 12



Get boxes



Tape and markers



Tell the building manager



Unplug the fridge the night before



Hire Llevo

they pack, load and assemble the same day

4 of 5



Use it when

- Services with a process: moving, paperwork, trips, weddings.
- B2B and productivity apps.



Avoid it when

- If the box looks like something you tap inside the ad.

MISTAKES THAT RUIN IT

- 01 Big boxes that invite a click.
- 02 A list of more than six items.
- 03 A blurry benefit in the last box.

What gets it rejected

● Meta

● Google

● TikTok

FLAGGED FOR

Meta prohibits boxes that do not work. Google restricts elements that look interactive.

HOW TO PASS

Small boxes, already ticked, integrated into the image. Never a giant empty box.

11

FORMAT 11 OF 12

● Use with care

Voice note

An audio bubble with a transcript. On video it sounds real and feels like a personal message.

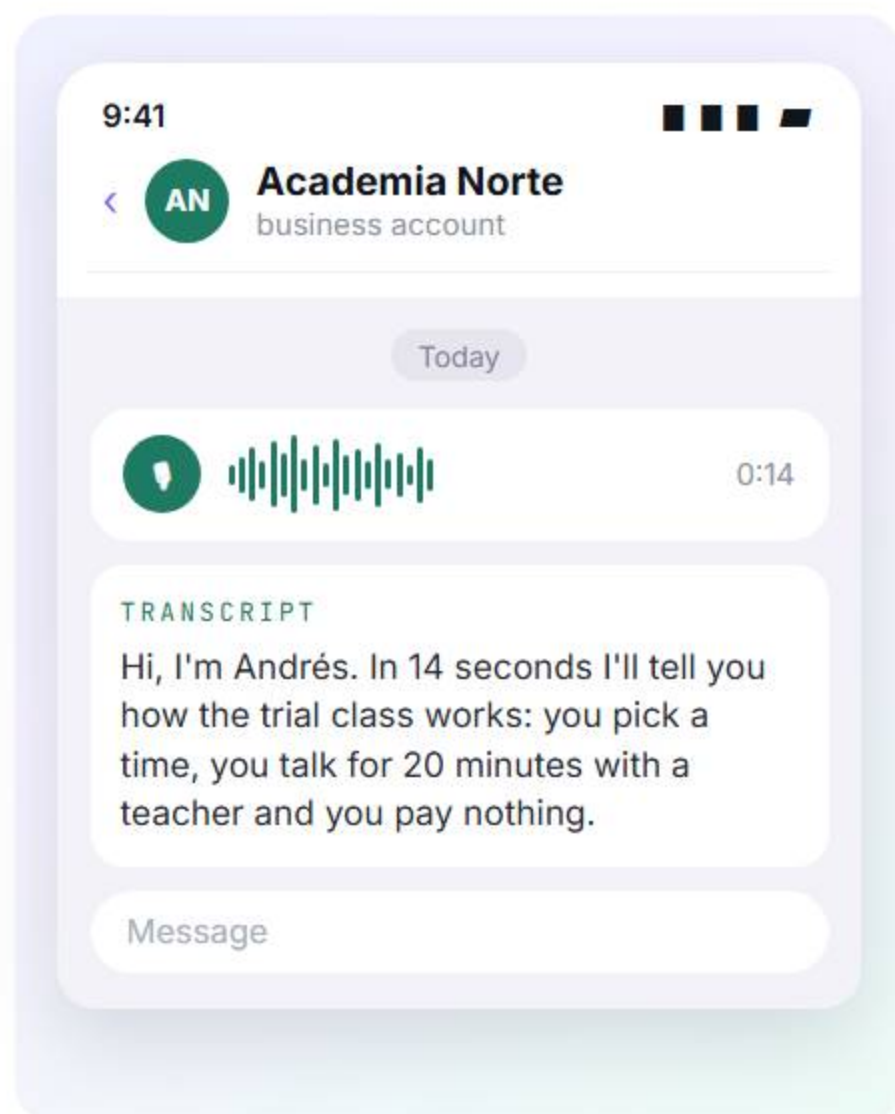
FITS

Education

Health and beauty

Local services

Apps



Use it when

- Video on Reels and TikTok with real audio.
- Close messages: education, health, services.



Avoid it when

- On a static image with a play button that does nothing.
- With a real person's cloned voice.

MISTAKES THAT RUIN IT

- 01 A play button on an image.
- 02 An AI voice imitating a real person.
- 03 Audio without subtitles.

What gets it rejected

● Meta

● Google

● TikTok

FLAGGED FOR

All three platforms ban fake play buttons. TikTok prohibits AI-made endorsements. An AI voice of a real person is a deepfake in the EU.

HOW TO PASS

Only on video with real audio. On static, no play icon: a microphone and a transcript.

12

FORMAT 12 OF 12

● Use with care

Email screenshot

An inbox with a subject line that hooks. It reads in half a second.

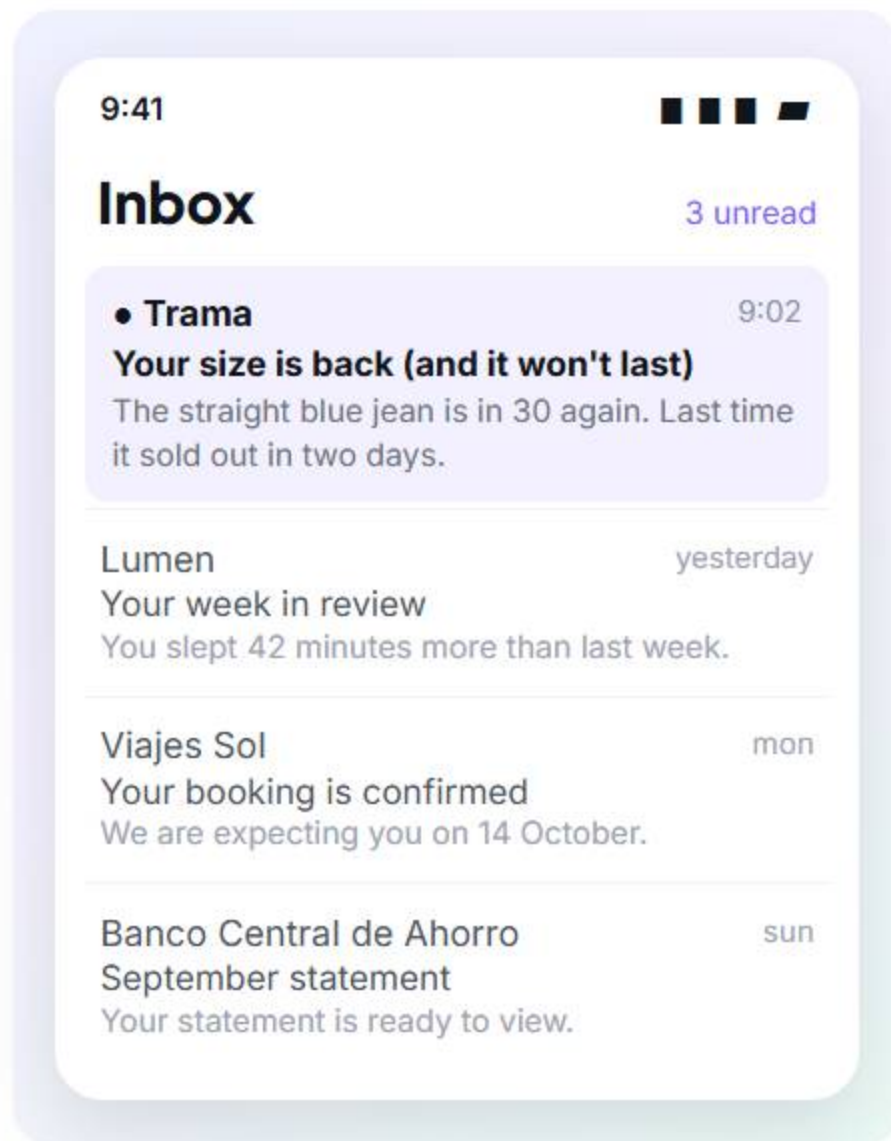
FITS

Ecommerce

SaaS

Media

Education



Use it when

- Ecommerce with restocks and launches.
- B2B with a strong newsletter.



Avoid it when

- If the sender looks like a bank, an institution or another company.
- With alert-style subject lines.

MISTAKES THAT RUIN IT

- 01 An impersonated sender.
- 02 "Your account will be suspended" subject lines.
- 03 A Gmail or Outlook logo.

What gets it rejected

● Meta

● Google

● TikTok

FLAGGED FOR

Impersonating institutions is fraud on Meta and phishing on Google. Fake system alerts are rejected by all three.

HOW TO PASS

The highlighted sender is your brand. An honest subject line. A generic inbox.

01

SUMMARY

Which format for which industry

Start with the filled cells for your industry. The coloured dot next to each format is its rejection risk.

	Ecommerce	SaaS and B2B	Local services	Health and beauty	Education	Finance
01 Messaging chat ●	○	○	●	●	●	○
02 Story aesthetic ●	●	—	●	●	○	—
03 Notes app note ●	○	●	○	○	●	●
04 Text post ●	○	●	○	—	●	●
05 Comment reply ●	●	○	○	●	○	—
06 Comment thread ●	○	●	—	—	○	●
07 Review screenshot ●	●	○	●	●	●	—
08 Editorial style ●	○	○	—	○	○	○
09 Search and autocomplete ●	—	●	○	○	●	○
10 Checklist ●	○	●	●	○	○	○
11 Voice note ●	—	○	●	●	●	○
12 Email screenshot ●	●	●	—	—	○	—

● Fits very well ○ Works with a good angle — Little sense

Health and finance have extra rules on all three platforms.

02

The rules of the game.

No platform forbids an ad from looking like content. What they reject is something else, and it is very specific.

Faking

a feature that does not exist

Impersonating

an app, an outlet or a person

Inventing

reviews, comments or results

02

RED LINE

Guaranteed rejection on all three

These elements take the ad down on Meta, Google and TikTok. Repeating them can restrict the whole account.



Fake notifications

Lock screens or alerts that imitate the phone.



System alerts

Errors, full memory, viruses. Google bans them explicitly.



Fake play

A play button over a static image.



Fake close

An X that closes nothing and goes to the site.



Fake carousel

Dots or arrows on a single image. TikTok names it.



Boxes and buttons

Controls with no function. Google limits buttons without context.



Celebrities without permission

Meta compares faces with facial recognition.



Other brands

Exact logos and interfaces of real apps or newspapers.



The quick test

If someone tapped that element expecting it to do something, and it does not, take it out.

What each one looks at

Meta

Facebook • Instagram • Messenger • Threads

- ✗ Prohibits images imitating play buttons, notifications or boxes that do not work.
- ✗ Bans impersonating an outlet, entity or association to promise benefits.
- ✗ Reviews the ad and the landing together: fake counters, hidden prices or different offers repeat the rejection.

KEY FACT 2026

Since June it detects third-party AI with C2PA metadata and applies the "AI info" label. If there is a realistic AI-made person, the label can sit next to "Sponsored".

Google

Demand Gen • YouTube • Display

- ✗ Does not allow ads that make it hard to understand they are an ad.
- ✗ Restricts loose buttons without context or out of proportion.
- ✗ Rejects anything imitating system alerts or disguised as someone else's content.

KEY FACT

For deceptive design there is no immediate suspension: it warns at least 7 days ahead. Use these in Demand Gen and YouTube, not in Search.

TikTok

In-feed • Spark Ads • TopView

- ✗ Names what is banned: fake play, fake close, fake carousel indicators, fake pop-ups.
- ✗ Prohibits AI-generated endorsements and requires labelling AI-made content.
- ✗ Offer, price and conditions have to match between ad and landing.

SAFE SHORTCUT

Spark Ads promotes a real organic post. It is the most native and cleanest way to do a "comment reply".

Where the line is

1

Did it really happen?

Reviews, comments and testimonials exist and you have permission.

2

Is it pretending to be something else?

An app, an outlet, an alert or a person that did not authorise it.

3

Is it clear who is speaking?

The brand and the commercial nature are clear.

United States

FTC

Since October 2024 it prohibits fake reviews and testimonials, including AI-made ones. Fines up to US\$51,744 per violation. Actors are fine if the testimonial is real.

Spain and the EU

Omnibus · AI Act

Adding or commissioning fake reviews is an unfair practice. From 2 August 2026 deepfakes have to be declared, with fines up to €15M or 3% of turnover.

Colombia

SIC

The advertising message has to be explicit, not presented as a spontaneous recommendation. Consumer Statute, Law 1480.

Mexico

Profeco

Article 32 of the LFPC requires advertising that is clear, truthful, verifiable and not misleading.

Informative summary, not legal advice. Chile, Argentina and Peru are not covered in this edition.

03

BEFORE YOU LAUNCH

Checklist

Ten checks. If they all pass, the ad passes.

-
- ☐ 01 Everything that looks clickable works, or you took it out.
 - ☐ 02 No logos, colours or exact interfaces from other apps or outlets.
 - ☐ 03 Reviews, comments and testimonials are real and you have permission.
 - ☐ 04 No celebrity or real person who has not authorised it.
 - ☐ 05 Realistic AI-made people, voices or scenes are labelled.
 - ☐ 06 The promise can be proven. No guaranteed income or cures.
 - ☐ 07 The landing says the same: price, offer, deadline. No fake counters.
 - ☐ 08 The landing has visible contact, policies and terms.
 - ☐ 09 It is clear who is advertising: your brand appears in the piece or the copy.
 - ☐ 10 You launch 3 to 5 formats at once and decide with data.
-



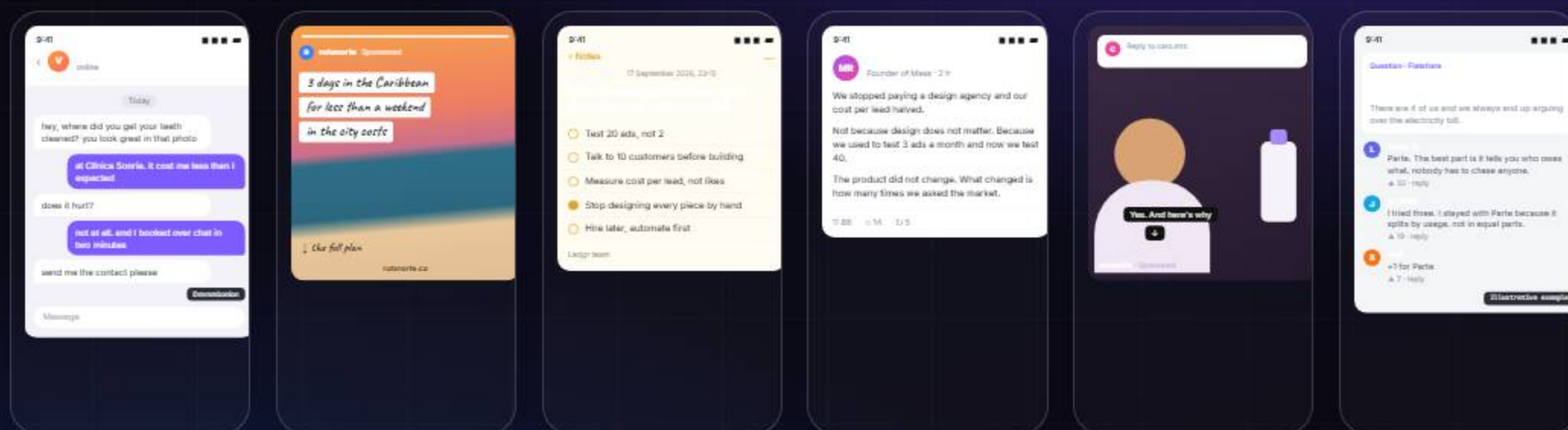
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03	Search Engine Land, "Why ugly ads outperform polished creative" (2026) searchengineland.com/ugly-ads-outperforming-polished-creative-475007	04	Meta Transparency Center, Unacceptable Business Practices transparency.meta.com/policies/ad-standards/fraud-scams/unacceptable-business-practices
05	Meta Transparency Center, Advertising Standards transparency.meta.com/policies/ad-standards	06	Meta, tests against celeb-bait with facial recognition about.fb.com/news/2024/10/testing-combat-scams-restore-compromised-accounts
07	"AI info" label on Meta ads (2026) ugcvids.ai/blog/meta-ai-generated-creative-ad-policy-2026	08	Meta, WhatsApp Brand Guidelines meta.com/brand/resources/whatsapp/whatsapp-brand
09	Google Ads, Misrepresentation: Misleading ad design support.google.com/adspolicy/answer/15937463	10	Google Ads, policy update (August 2026) support.google.com/adspolicy/answer/17600038
11	Google Ads, Best practices for responsive display ads support.google.com/google-ads/answer/9823397	12	TikTok Ads, Misleading and false content ads.tiktok.com/help/article/tiktok-ads-policy-misleading-and-false-content
13	TikTok Ads, Deceptive practices ads.tiktok.com/help/article/tiktok-ads-policy-deceptive-practices	14	FTC, Consumer Reviews and Testimonials Rule: Q&A ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/consumer-reviews-testimonials-rule-questions-answers
15	Alston & Bird, FTC Final Rule on Fake Reviews (2024) alston.com/en/insights/publications/2024/10/ftc-issues-final-rule-on-fake-reviews-testimonials	16	RDL 24/2021 and Law 3/1991 on Unfair Competition (Spain) boe.es/buscar/act.php?id=BOE-A-1991-628
17	European Commission, obligations under art. 50 of the AI Act digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/faqs/transparency-obligations-under-article-50-ai-act	18	Davis+Gilbert, AI Act and advertising (2026) dglaw.com/eu-ai-act-guidance-expands-ai-disclosure-rules-for-advertisers-and-pr-teams
19	SIC Colombia, good practice guide with influencers sic.gov.co	20	Profeco, advertising guide for influencers and art. 32 LFPC profeco.gob.mx/influencers

Consulted in September 2026. Policies change: check the current version before launching. All brands, people and interfaces in the examples are invented.

Design once. Produce all 12.

Adle generates these formats with your brand, in every size and in batch.
And it launches them on Meta, Google and TikTok.



Try it at

adle.ai